

← Case report for event ID: 1020

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1020	Powershell Script in Downloads Folder.	A powershell script was created in the Downloads folder.	Execution	Low	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:52

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:50:24.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:50:24.164, a PowerShell script named "PowerView.ps1" was created in the user's Downloads folder ("C:\Users\michael.ascot\Downloads\PowerView.ps1") via powershell.exe (PID 9060). The creation of this script in a user-accessible location is unusual and potentially indicates preparation for reconnaissance or lateral movement.

-Malware Identified: None identified. Suspicious script detected.

-Additional Investigation:

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert

- Alert 1020: Execution
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterprise

Apps

Messages

Settings

Activity

Help

Find

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Search & Reporting

Save As

Create Table View

Close

New Search

1 process.name="powershell.exe" host.name="win-3450"

10 of 90 events matched

No Event Sampling

6 day window

Job

Format

Verbose Mode

Events (10)

Patterns

Statistics

Visualization

Format Timeline

Zoom Out

Zoom to Selection

Deselect

1 hour per column

List

Format

50 Per Page

< Hide Fields

All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a dns.answers.data 2

a dns.question.name 2

a dns.resolved_ip 2

a event.action 3

event.code 3

a file.path 7

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a network.protocol 1

a process.name 1

process.pid 4

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 9

4 more fields

+ Extract New Fields

>

12/27/25

3:54:48.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: File created (rule: FileCreate)

event.code: 11

file.path: C:\Users\michael.ascot\Downloads\exfiltration\exfilt8me.zip

host.name: win-3450

process.name: powershell.exe

process.pid: 3728

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:54:48.248

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.178.106:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

>

12/27/25

3:53:25.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: File created (rule: FileCreate)

event.code: 11

file.path: C:\Users\michael.ascot\Downloads\exfiltration

host.name: win-3450

process.name: powershell.exe

process.pid: 3728

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:53:25.248

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.178.106:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

>

12/27/25

3:51:51.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

SIEM Investigation

- For reference: the CEO had 10 PowerShell.exe processes in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:50:24.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:50:24.164, a PowerShell script named `PowerView.ps1` was created in the user's Downloads folder (`C:\Users\michael.ascot\Downloads\PowerView.ps1`) via powershell.exe (PID 9060). The creation of this script in a user-accessible location is unusual and potentially indicates preparation for reconnaissance or lateral movement.

-Malware Identified: None identified. Suspicious script detected.

-Additional Investigation:

SIEM Investigation:

For reference: the CEO had 10 powershell.exe process in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Additional info:

Script: `PowerView.ps1` is a well-known PowerShell tool often used for Active Directory enumeration in penetration testing and malicious activity.

Why This Is Uncommon: Creating or dropping this script in a Downloads folder is atypical for standard user activity and warrants validation of intent.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation